

VIP 1-20

Brainstroming Session

- What would each person who attended in person meets gain?
 - Should there be any structure during these meetings?
 - Guidelines?
 - Code of conducts?
- We should recruit other military spouses that have gone through the process
 - Get their testimonial
 - What incentives would we give them?
- Companies, what are their incentives?
 - Hire people
 - Companies can come onto our platform to look for employees.
- Wider net of support
 - How do you provide?
 - How can we create a "third place"?

TODO

- ✓ ~~Continue brainstorming~~
 - ✓ ~~Think about why would people come to our website?~~
 - ✓ ~~How would our tools help with larger goals?~~

VIP 1-27

Previous Research

New Features

- Generate action plans
- rate how useful each resource is and flag it if its outdated

Crowdsourcing:

- Short prompts about helpfulness
 - asking spouses what resource helped you the most?
 - which office solved our problem?
 - anonymous
- peer verified (on community page)
 - confirm similar experiences
 - mentors can validate advice

Research methods for better ideas

- Do interviews with spouses who use the platform
 - Newly relocated spouses
 - Spouses that has relocated a lot
- asks questions about the process of settling down. how long did it take. any surprising problems. what resources did you look at.
 - based off of their answers we might be able to build a new feature to help with their problem
 - or what resources to prioritize or highlight the most.

Meeting

Discussed crowdsourcing ideas for the platform

- interviews with spouses
 - interview various spouses in different situations about their process of relocating
 - ask about what resources they found most helpful
 - based off of their answers, build features to help with that or highlight resources that are most helpful
- Events + Community

- career fairs
- community group
- Gamified Interactions
 - scoring mentors and coaches
 - community reputation
- Career Confidence Builder
 - enhancing resume or profile
- Successful Stories
 - highlighting those who used career corp successfully

Which direction should we go towards for the entire project? Mentoring or community?

- group thought about going for community
- I thought that we should stick with mentoring due to the heavy reliance of people participating in the community activities.
 - **Carl: We should still go towards community because having community builds strong bonds. Social media and online platforms mainly only nurture weak bonds.**

TODO

- ☒ ~~Narrow down onto an idea that you want the entire class to focus on. Convince the class to work on the idea.~~
- ☒ ~~What would we want to add to our previous semester's work?~~
- ☒ ~~OR think about: are there any new directions we can go into? any new ideas?~~

VIP 2-3

Previous HW - "Pitch" for this semester

Overview:

Military spouses frequently relocate and that destroys their previous employment progression and social networks. Information to help this exists out there but are scattered. CareerCorps is the platform that turns relocation into a guided and supported process. My vision of the project is a platform that helps military spouses regain stability and confidence by providing them with exactly what they need through a 30-day customized plan. We use a combination of AI and crowdsourcing like last semester to build this platform. This 30-day plan will be generated by AI and then backed by the community through insights and comments from other spouses who have gone through the same steps. This platform will also act as a tool to help spouses find their "third place". Essentially a CareerCorps will be a platform that uses AI to do the bulk of the work (generating the plan), crowdsourcing to verify (other spouses and mentors), and community to build deep connections and help find a "third place".

When the spouse first joins the platform:

- Answer a small set of questions to find out what their goal is
 - Are you new to the area?
 - Looking for employment?
 - Need housing? Childcare? Healthcare?
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Based off of these questions, AI generates a 30-day plan to quickly help them get back on their feet. Spouses will know exactly what to do and when to do it. This plan is generated using trusted official base and community resources.

Each task has:

- description
- deadline (soft deadline)
- relevant offices, websites, contacts
- what documents are needed
- how long it should take

Additionally for each task other spouses can comment and contribute

- what worked for them or didn't
- documents to bring
- how long it took for them to complete the task
- common mistakes

Mentors can come in and verify or expand upon those comments. Mentors can also come in and refine the AI-generated plans or create a completely new customized one specifically for the spouse if their situation is very unique.

On the side, we will re-use what we created last semester. The chatbot and that will help them summarize long documents or answer any follow up questions about the plan or resources.

Additionally, to help spouses find deep connections and their "third place", the platform will provide optional community spaces. Spouses can go attend them if they want to. The community is aligned with their goals and is not mandatory to attend.

Conclusion:

Basically a platform that will generate a standard action plan to help them get back on their feet and based off of their specific goals. We use AI to help create these plans. We use spouses to add their insights to these steps in the plan. Mentors are there to monitor and verify information and also help edit or create a customized plan for the spouse. Chatbot comes in to help with small questions and to summarize long resources. And existing groups and the community can act as a "third place", providing deep connection if the spouse wishes to join.

Meeting Results

Each person pitch their idea:

- Idea One: Build one big cohesive app with all of the implementations that was built last semester.
- Idea Two: App to build career goals. Help the user and also build a community along with helping.
- Idea Three: Unify the three groups. We should also test out how much engagement the app would have
- Idea Four: Test what we have so far, see if it works.

TODO

- ☒ ~~Think about an idea that would fit "personalized plan for goals"~~

VIP 2-10

Previous HW - Go more in to detail about "personalized plans for goals", have a concrete idea ready to go

Want to focus mainly on creating a 30-day plan for their specific goals (jobs).

Core Idea

CareerCorps generates a customized 30-day action plan for military spouses after relocation using a conversational way of taking in the user's information instead of traditional forms.

Entry Experience

User sees one prompt and one input box. The prompt asks what their primary goal is, or what is your current situation?

They describe their situation in their own words (e.g., job search, childcare, housing).

Suggested goals appear as they type, but free input is encouraged.

Conversational Intake

We take this input and convert it into a profile.

- primary goal
- secondary goals
- constraints (remote vs in-person, licensing, urgency)
- location

If key information is missing, the system asks **1–3 short follow-up questions** conversationally—only what's needed.

For example, if they are looking for jobs, but they didn't mention anywhere in their input where they were located, we will ask a follow up question clarifying that field. These fields are defined by us, and it can vary based off of the specific goals they have.

- If their goal is to look for housing, we don't need to ask them about their previous employment experience.

- We only want to get the bare minimum for us to create a plan. They can add additional information about themselves at the end
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Visible Understanding

A live profile card updates as users respond (goal, timeline, constraints), so it feels like the system is understanding them, not collecting fields.

30-Day Plan Generation

Once the profile is complete:

- the system generates a **goal-specific 30-day plan**
- built from predefined task templates
- personalized with AI

Each task includes:

- what to do
- when to do it
- where/who to contact
- required documents
- estimated time

The plan becomes the main interface.

Supporting Tools

- A chatbot (from last semester) explains steps and summarizes resources.
 - Community insights and mentor input validate and refine the plan.
 - How do we gather community insights?
 - Whenever another spouse completes the same task, a prompt will show up and ask them about how it went. Can comment further if they want to.
 - Mentors will go in and validate/monitor the comments
 - Community spaces act as an optional “third place,” aligned with user goals.
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Meeting

- The user knows what they want, but they feel like there is a gap before they can reach it
 - They want this specific job, but they don't feel like they have the skills to get there
 - False Gap (they actually are qualified but not confident)
 - True Gap (they need a certificate or degree)

How do we identify and fill in those gaps?